that he decided to join the fight for freedom. Over the next three decades, Patel grew into an important and well-respected member of the Indian National Congress, with Gandhi coming to rely on his pragmatism, organizational skills and ability to accomplish what he set out to achieve. By the time the British agreed to leave India, Patel was a front runner to be the first prime minister of India, although he was eventually appointed home minister and deputy prime minister.



After he joined the independence movement, Patel gave up his previous fondness for European clothing and followed Gandhi in adopting a simple lifestyle.

PATEL AND NEHRU

The socialist, secular Nehru and the economically and socially conservative Patel often disagreed on key issues. Gandhi frequently had to make peace between them, for he believed that the new India needed both men in order to grow and flourish. In the end, Patel and Nehru grew to respect each other and worked closely together for many years.

The man of action